Astro Bodyshop

ASTRO BODYSHOP · FREE

Start Here

The warm-up, your first session, and the three numbers that decide whether any of it shows. Taken straight out of the Recomposition programme, not written around it.

COST	TAKES	TRACKS	COACH
NOTHING	ABOUT AN HOUR	THREE	AYO BALOGUN

What this is

This is the real first session from the Recomposition programme, printed in full. Same exercises, same sets, same reps, same cues. Nothing has been watered down to make you want the paid one.

You get the warm-up, the whole of Day 1 written three ways, the ten minutes of stretching that follow it, and the way to work out what you should be eating. That last part is worth having even if you never train a single day of mine.

What is not in here is the other four days, and the eight weeks of progress that turn one good session into a different body. That is the programme, and it costs ₦50,000.

DO THE SESSION FIRST

Read this once, then go and train. An hour of honest work will tell you more about whether I know what I am doing than any amount of reading will.

READ THIS FIRST

This book gives you training and nutrition guidance. It is not medical advice. Talk to a doctor before you start, and especially if you are pregnant, coming back from an injury or an operation, or being treated for anything to do with your heart, your joints or your blood pressure.

You train at your own risk. Warm up before every session. Use weights you can control with good form. **Stop straight away and get medical help** if you feel pain in your chest, go dizzy or faint, or something feels badly wrong.

Sharp pain, pinching, or pain right on a joint line means stop that exercise. It does not mean work around it. Burning muscles and honest tiredness are meant to be there. Pain is not.

01

Pick your column

Every exercise below is written three ways. Read along the row and take the one that matches your situation.

THE THREE TRACKS

TRACK	TAKE THIS ONE IF	WHAT CHANGES
In the gym	You have barbells, machines and cables	Nothing. The first column is written for you.
At home	You train with a loaded backpack and some bands	The kit changes. Sets, reps and progress are identical. Where you cannot add weight you add difficulty instead. Slow the lowering down, then add a pause, then go to one limb at a time.
Joint-friendly	A knee, shoulder, hip or back has history, or heavy loading hurts	Kinder versions of the same movements, and you work one step further from your limit. Nothing here is made easy. It is made repeatable.

Effort, and why there are no percentages

Telling you to lift 72.5 kg on a day I cannot see you would be a guess. Every set has an effort number instead. It means how many more reps you could have done before your form broke down. On the joint-friendly column, take one off every number below.

EFFORT	WHAT THAT FELT LIKE
6	Four or more reps left in the tank. Comfortable.
7	Three reps left. Working, but not straining.
8	Two reps left. The weight slows down on the last one.
9	One rep left. Properly hard.
10	*Nothing left and your form falls apart. Not used here.*

02

The warm-up

Eight minutes. Every session. No exceptions.

EVERY SESSION

MOVEMENT	TIME	WHY
Easy cardio. A bike, a rower or a brisk walk.	3 to 5 min	Get warm
Leg swings, forwards and back then side to side	10 each	Open the hips up
Cat and cow	8 reps	Wake the back up one bit at a time
Band pull-apart	15 reps	Switch the upper back on
Bodyweight squat, as deep as is comfortable	10 reps	Groove the movement

THEN ON YOUR FIRST EXERCISE ONLY

SET	WEIGHT	REPS
Empty bar or very light	Nothing on it	10
About half	50%	5
About seventy per cent	70%	3
About eighty-five per cent	85%	1
First working set	100%	As written

03

Your first session

Legs, quads first. Rest two to three minutes after the first two exercises, sixty to ninety seconds after the rest.

DAY 1. LEGS, QUADS FIRST

EXERCISE (IN THE GYM)	SETS X REPS	EFFORT	AT HOME	JOINT-FRIENDLY
MAIN LIFTS				
Back Squat	4 × 6–8	7–8	Backpack squat, heels on a book	Goblet squat or box squat
Leg Press	3 × 10–12	8	Backpack split squat	Leg press, shorter range
SUPPORTING WORK				
Walking Lunge	3 × 10 / leg	7	Reverse lunge holding a backpack	Split squat, front foot on a step
Leg Extension	3 × 12–15	8	Sissy squat holding a doorframe	As written, slower
Standing Calf Raise	4 × 12–15	8	One-leg calf raise off a step	Seated calf raise
CORE				
Hanging Knee Raise	3 × 10–15	8	Lying leg raise	Dead bug, 8 each side

How to do each one

Four things decide the rep. Setting up, the way down, how far you go, and the mistake almost everyone makes.

Back Squat

Set up Bar resting on the muscle across the back of your shoulders. Feet a little wider than your hips, toes turned out slightly.

The way down Sit straight down between your hips. Three seconds. Chest stays up.

How far Hip crease below the top of your knee. Stop where your back is still flat.

The usual mistake Knees falling inwards as you stand up. Push them out against the floor.

Leg Press

Set up Feet flat and about hip width, in the middle of the plate. Back and hips pressed into the seat.

The way down Lower it under control until your knees come near your chest.

How far As deep as you can go before your hips start to lift off the seat.

The usual mistake Snapping your knees straight at the top. Stop just short of locked.

Walking Lunge

Set up Stand tall. Step out far enough that your front shin stays almost upright.

The way down	Drop your back knee straight down until it nearly touches the floor.
How far	Back knee an inch off the ground, front heel flat the whole way.
The usual mistake	Short choppy steps. They load the knee instead of the glute.

Leg Extension

Set up	Back against the pad. Knee lined up with the pivot of the machine.
The way down	Three seconds down, and never let the weights touch at the bottom.
How far	All the way straight, with a one second squeeze at the top.
The usual mistake	Swinging your body to throw the weight up.

Standing Calf Raise

Set up	Balls of your feet on the step. Knees straight and staying straight.
The way down	Two seconds down into a deep stretch. No bouncing.
How far	Heel below the step at the bottom, right up on your big toe at the top.
The usual mistake	Fast little pulses. Calves grow from the stretch, not the count.

Hanging Knee Raise

Set up	Hang with your shoulders pulled down and away from your ears.
The way down	Control your legs back down. No swing into the next one.
How far	Knees above your hips, lower back rounding a little at the top.
The usual mistake	Using momentum. If you are swinging, halve the reps.

> WHEN TO ADD WEIGHT
>
> When you hit the top of the rep range on every set at the effort written, put a little more on next time. Two and a half kilos on an upper body lift, five on a lower body one. If that drops you to the bottom of the rep range, that is exactly right.

04

Ten minutes after

Stretch warm, never cold. The end of a session is the right time for it.

STRETCH	HOLD OR REPS	WHAT IT IS FOR
Hip stretch, back knee down and back foot up on a chair. Each side.	45 sec	The front of the hip, which sitting and squatting both shorten
Sitting hip rotations, one leg in front and one out to the side	8 each side	Turning the hip in and out
Seated hamstring stretch, each side	45 sec	The back of the thigh after hinging
Upper back stretch over a bench or a rolled towel	8 reps	The upper back, which decides how far overhead you can reach
Chest stretch in a doorway, each side	45 sec	The chest after pressing
Child’s pose, reaching over to one side	45 sec each side	The lats and lower back

05

Your numbers

Training builds the muscle. What you eat decides whether anyone gets to see it.

Three numbers and a set of scales. About ten minutes of arithmetic, and it is the part most people skip and then wonder why nothing changed.

Step one. What you burn now.

Multiply your bodyweight in kilos by 31 if you sit down most of the day, 34 if you are on your feet a fair bit, or 37 if your job is physical. That is roughly what you burn in a day with five training sessions in the week. It is an estimate. Two weeks of weighing yourself will tell you how good an estimate it was.

Step two. What you eat.

Take 400 calories off that number. Not 1,000. A small shortfall is what lets you keep the muscle while the fat comes off. Anything more aggressive and you are just on a diet with some weights in it.

Step three. Where those calories come from.

WHAT	HOW MUCH	WHY
Protein	2 grams per kilo of bodyweight	The one number that is not negotiable. Hit it every day, training or not.
Fat	0.8 grams per kilo	Hormones, joints, and food that is worth eating
Carbs	Whatever calories are left	Fuel for the sessions

> **WEIGH YOURSELF PROPERLY**
>
> First thing, after the toilet, before anything to eat or drink. Every day. Then ignore every single day and compare this week's average to last week's. Weight moves with salt, sleep, stress and what is still in your gut. One day tells you nothing.

06

The other four days

What the rest of the week looks like, and where to get it.

DAY	SESSION	WHAT IT COVERS
Day 1	Legs	*You just did this one*
Day 2	Push	Chest, shoulders, triceps
Day 3	Pull	Back and biceps
Day 4	Legs again	Hamstrings and glutes
Day 5	Upper body	Everything the first three days left behind

Monday, Tuesday, Wednesday, Friday, Saturday. Two days on, one off, two on, one off.

What the full programme adds

- **The other four sessions**, written the same three ways
- **Eight weeks of progress.** The sessions stay the same. What changes is how many sets you do and how hard you push them, and getting that order right is most of the job.
- **What to change when the scale stops moving**, which it will, around week three
- **The longer stretching routine** for your days off
- **A logbook**, because the numbers are the only honest record of whether you are getting stronger
- **A check-in with me every Sunday** on WhatsApp for the full eight weeks. Being accountable to someone is the biggest single difference between people who finish and people who go quiet in week three.

> RECOMPOSITION. ₦50,000, OR $36.
>
> Eight weeks, five days a week, three ways to run every session. At **astrobodyshop.fit**.
>
> And every movement in the programme, in all three columns, with the cues that decide each rep, is free and open at **astrobodyshop.fit/exercises**. No email, no login.

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Start Here is free. Send it to anyone you like, print it, put it on a noticeboard at your gym. The only thing I ask is that you leave it as it is.

Questions on any of it, message me on WhatsApp. I answer these myself.

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